MERIDIAN CARE PLUS

Individual Health Policy

Meridian Health Assurance Company Limited
Meridian House, Harbour Business District, Mumbai

Policy Wording · Version 1.0 · Product Code MHA-HLT-CP-IND-V1

FICTIONAL DOCUMENT. Meridian Health Assurance Company Limited and the Meridian Care Plus product do not exist. This wording was written for educational and software-testing purposes (for example, as a knowledge base for a retrieval-augmented generation exercise). It is not an insurance contract and must not be relied upon for any real insurance decision.

This document is the contract of insurance between Meridian Health Assurance Company Limited and the Policyholder named in the Policy Schedule. It is made on the basis of the proposal form and declarations submitted by the Policyholder and the premium received by the Company. Each clause of this Policy is identified by a number so that it can be cited individually. Amounts are in Indian Rupees (INR).

1. DEFINITIONS

1.1 **Interpretation.** The words and expressions listed in this Section 1 have the meanings given to them wherever they appear in this Policy, whether or not they begin with a capital letter. A reference to a numbered clause or Section is a reference to that clause or Section of this Policy. Headings are for convenience of reference only. “Company” means Meridian Health Assurance Company Limited and includes any third-party administrator authorised by it to act on its behalf. “Insured Person” means the person named as such in the Policy Schedule. The Policy Schedule, the Schedule of Benefits in Section 16 and any endorsement issued by the Company form part of this Policy and are to be read together with it.

1.2 **Accident.** An Accident is a sudden, unforeseen and involuntary event caused by external, visible and violent means. “Accidental” has a corresponding meaning.

1.3 **Illness.** An Illness is a sickness or a disease or pathological condition leading to the impairment of normal physiological function, which first manifests itself or is first diagnosed during the Policy Year and requires Medical Treatment. Illness does not include an injury caused by an Accident.

1.4 **Hospital.** A Hospital is an institution established in India for in-patient care and Day-Care Procedures which (a) is registered with the local authorities under the applicable clinical establishments law; (b) has at least ten in-patient beds in a town with a population of less than ten lakh and at least fifteen in-patient beds in any other place; (c) has qualified nursing staff under its employment round the clock; (d) has qualified Medical Practitioners in charge round the clock; (e) has a fully equipped operation theatre of its own where surgical procedures are carried out; and (f) maintains daily records of patients and makes them accessible to the Company’s authorised personnel. A nursing home, rest home, health spa, old-age home, rehabilitation centre or hotel is not a Hospital.

1.5 **Hospitalization.** In this Policy:

1.5.1 Hospitalization means admission to a Hospital as an in-patient for a minimum period of twenty-four (24) consecutive hours for the purpose of receiving Medically Necessary treatment for an Illness or an Accident.

1.5.2 The minimum period in clause 1.5.1 does not apply to a Day-Care Procedure covered under Section 4.

1.5.3 A stay in a Hospital solely for diagnostic investigation, evaluation or observation, or during which no active treatment is given, is not Hospitalization even if it exceeds twenty-four (24) hours.

1.6 **Day-Care Procedure.** A Day-Care Procedure is a medical or surgical procedure undertaken under general or local anaesthesia in a Hospital or day-care centre in less than twenty-four (24) hours because of technological advancement, and which would otherwise have required a Hospital stay of more than twenty-four (24) hours. Treatment taken in the outpatient department of a Hospital is not a Day-Care Procedure.

1.7 **Medical Necessity.** Medically Necessary treatment is treatment which (a) is required for the diagnosis or treatment of an Illness or an injury; (b) is in accordance with generally accepted standards of medical practice in India; (c) is not primarily for the convenience of the Insured Person or the Medical Practitioner; (d) could not have been safely provided in a lower-cost setting or at a lower level of care; and (e) is provided at the appropriate level and for the appropriate duration.

1.8 **Network Hospital.** A Network Hospital is a Hospital or day-care centre that has an agreement with the Company to provide cashless treatment to Insured Persons and that appears on the list of network providers published by the Company on the date of admission. A Hospital that is not a Network Hospital is a Non-Network Hospital.

1.9 **Pre-Existing Condition.** A Pre-Existing Condition is any condition, ailment, injury or disease (a) that was diagnosed by a Medical Practitioner within forty-eight (48) months before the effective date of the first policy issued by the Company to the Insured Person; or (b) for which medical advice or treatment was recommended by, or received from, a Medical Practitioner within forty-eight (48) months before that date.

1.10 **Waiting Period.** A Waiting Period is a period, measured from the inception date of the first policy issued by the Company to the Insured Person (and continued on renewal under clause 8.6), during which a claim of the kind described in Section 8 or Section 9 is not payable.

1.11 **Emergency.** An Emergency is a medical condition or symptom resulting in an acute medical crisis that requires immediate medical or surgical attention in order to prevent death or serious and permanent impairment of health, and in which delay to obtain pre-authorization would endanger the life or health of the Insured Person. “Emergency Hospitalization” means Hospitalization that begins as a result of an Emergency.

1.12 **Medical Practitioner.** A Medical Practitioner is a person who holds a valid registration from a State Medical Council or equivalent authority in India and who acts within the scope of that registration. The Insured Person, and the Insured Person's spouse, parents, children and siblings, are not Medical Practitioners for the purposes of this Policy in relation to the Insured Person's own treatment.

1.13 **AYUSH Treatment.** AYUSH Treatment is in-patient treatment under the Ayurveda, Yoga and Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha or Homeopathy systems of medicine, given in an AYUSH Hospital. An AYUSH Hospital is a Hospital or day-care centre that meets the requirements of clause 1.4 (adapted for the relevant system), is recognised under the applicable AYUSH law and is under the charge of a registered AYUSH practitioner.

1.14 **Policy Year.** A Policy Year is each period of twelve (12) months beginning on the inception date shown in the Policy Schedule or on a renewal date.

1.15 **Sum Insured.** The Sum Insured is the amount shown in the Policy Schedule for the Plan chosen by the Policyholder. It is the maximum liability of the Company for all claims in a Policy Year, as adjusted under Section 14.

1.16 **Reasonable and Customary Charges.** Reasonable and Customary Charges are charges for services or supplies that are the standard charge of the specific provider and are consistent with the prevailing charges in the same geographical area for identical or similar services, taking into account the nature of the Illness or injury and the complexity of the treatment.

1.17 **Pre-Hospitalization and Post-Hospitalization.**

1.17.1 Pre-Hospitalization means the period of thirty (30) days immediately before the date of admission to the Hospital.

1.17.2 Post-Hospitalization means the period of sixty (60) days immediately after the date of discharge from the Hospital.

1.18 **Congenital Anomaly.** A Congenital Anomaly is a condition present from birth. "Congenital Internal Anomaly" means one that is not visible on external examination and involves the internal organs or systems. "Congenital External Anomaly" means one that is visible and accessible on the external parts of the body.

2. SCOPE OF COVER

2.1 **Insuring Clause.** Subject to the terms, conditions, limits, sub-limits, Waiting Periods and exclusions of this Policy, and provided that the premium has been paid, if during a Policy Year the Insured Person suffers an Illness or sustains an injury through an Accident and, as a consequence, incurs expenses for a benefit described in Sections 3 to 7, the Company shall indemnify the Insured Person for the Reasonable and Customary Charges of Medically Necessary treatment, up to the Sum Insured and the applicable sub-limits.

2.2 **Eligibility.** A person may be proposed for cover if aged between eighteen (18) and sixty-five (65) completed years on the date of the proposal. Acceptance of the proposal is at the Company's discretion after underwriting. Once accepted, the Policy is renewable for life in accordance with clause 15.5.

2.3 **Territorial Scope.** The Policy covers treatment received in India only. Expenses incurred for treatment outside India are not payable.

2.4 **Plan Options.** The Policy is issued under Plan A, Plan B or Plan C, as shown in the Policy Schedule. The Sum Insured and the monetary limits for each Plan are set out in the Schedule of Benefits in Section 16.

2.5 **Order of Precedence.** Where provisions of this Policy overlap or conflict, the following rules apply:

2.5.1 Where a general provision and a specific provision deal with the same subject matter but state different limits or conditions, the specific provision prevails.

2.5.2 Where a clause states that it applies "notwithstanding" another clause, the clause containing the word "notwithstanding" prevails over the clause it names, but only to the extent stated.

2.5.3 An exception stated within an exclusion in Section 10 prevails over that exclusion, but only if every condition attached to the exception is satisfied.

2.5.4 If a monetary amount stated in the body of this Policy differs from the amount for the same benefit in the Schedule of Benefits, the amount in the Schedule of Benefits prevails. The conditions of a benefit are governed by the body of this Policy.

3. INPATIENT HOSPITALIZATION

3.1 **Covered Expenses.** If the Insured Person is admitted to a Hospital on Hospitalization, the Company shall pay the following Reasonable and Customary Charges, subject to clauses 3.2 and 3.3 and Section 11: (a) room rent, boarding and nursing charges; (b) fees of the surgeon, anaesthetist, physician and specialists; (c) anaesthesia, blood, oxygen, operation theatre charges, medicines and drugs administered during the stay; (d) diagnostic imaging and laboratory tests forming part of the treatment; and (e) internal implants and prostheses that are intrinsic to a covered surgical procedure, such as pacemakers, cardiac stents and joint implants.

3.2 **Room Rent.** Room rent is payable only up to the daily limit stated in clause 11.1 for the room category occupied. If the Insured Person occupies a room that costs more than that limit, clause 11.3 applies to the associated charges.

3.3 **Intensive Care.** Charges for an intensive care unit are payable up to the daily limit stated in clause 11.2. The limit in clause 11.1 does not apply to intensive care charges.

3.4 **Pre-Hospitalization Expenses.** The Company shall pay Medically Necessary expenses incurred during the Pre-Hospitalization period if (a) they relate to the same Illness or injury for which the Insured Person is subsequently hospitalised; (b) the Hospitalization claim is admissible under this Policy; and (c) the treatment was recommended by a Medical Practitioner. These expenses are payable on a reimbursement basis only.

3.5 **Post-Hospitalization Expenses.** The Company shall pay Medically Necessary expenses incurred during the Post-Hospitalization period, including consultations, prescribed medicines and diagnostic tests, if they relate to the same Illness or injury for which the Insured Person was hospitalised and the Hospitalization claim is admissible. These expenses are payable on a reimbursement basis only.

3.6 **AYUSH Treatment.** The Company shall pay expenses for AYUSH Treatment during Hospitalization, up to fifty per cent (50%) of the Sum Insured in a Policy Year. Clauses 3.4 and 3.5 do not apply to AYUSH Treatment.

3.7 **Domiciliary Hospitalization.** The Company shall pay for treatment taken at home for a period exceeding three (3) consecutive days, up to ten per cent (10%) of the Sum Insured in a Policy Year, where (a) the Insured Person’s condition is such that the patient cannot be moved to a Hospital, or (b) the patient cannot be admitted to a Hospital for lack of a bed, and the treatment is given on the advice of a Medical Practitioner. Domiciliary treatment is not payable for asthma, bronchitis, tonsillitis and upper respiratory tract infections including cough, cold and influenza, arthritis, gout, rheumatism, diabetes mellitus, hypertension, or psychiatric and psychosomatic disorders.

3.8 **Organ Donor Expenses.** If the Insured Person is the recipient of an organ transplant that is permitted by law, the Company shall pay the in-patient Hospitalization expenses of the donor that are directly related to the harvesting of the organ, up to the Sum Insured. The cost of the organ itself, the donor’s transport and any complication in the donor after discharge are not payable.

4. DAY-CARE PROCEDURES

4.1 **Cover for Day-Care Procedures.** The Company shall pay the Reasonable and Customary Charges of a Day-Care Procedure that is Medically Necessary and performed in a Hospital or day-care centre, even though the Insured Person is not admitted for twenty-four (24) hours, subject to clause 1.6 and the other terms of this Policy.

4.2 **Illustrative List.** Day-Care Procedures include (a) haemodialysis; (b) chemotherapy and radiotherapy; (c) cataract surgery; (d) lithotripsy for urinary stones; (e) coronary angioplasty; (f) dilatation and curettage; (g) tonsillectomy and adenoidectomy; (h) arthroscopic knee procedures; (i) laparoscopic hernia repair; and (j) surgical treatment of fistula-in-ano. The Waiting Periods in Sections 8 and 9 apply to a Day-Care Procedure in the same way as they apply to Hospitalization.

4.3 **Procedures Not Listed.** The list in clause 4.2 is illustrative and not exhaustive. A procedure not listed in clause 4.2 is covered as a Day-Care Procedure only if the Company confirms in writing, before the procedure, that the procedure satisfies clause 1.6.

4.4 **Cataract Surgery.** Notwithstanding clause 10.4 and subject to clause 8.3, the Company shall pay for cataract surgery up to the per-eye limit stated in the Schedule of Benefits. The limit applies separately to each eye and includes surgeon's fees, the intra-ocular lens, consumables, and Pre-Hospitalization and Post-Hospitalization expenses. A standard monofocal lens is payable. Any additional cost of a premium lens (including multifocal and toric lenses) is borne by the Insured Person. Hospitalization for a complication of cataract surgery is assessed separately under Section 3 and is not subject to the per-eye limit.

4.5 **Room Rent and Pre/Post-Hospitalization for Day-Care.** The room rent limit in clause 11.1 and the proportionate deduction in clause 11.3 do not apply to a Day-Care Procedure. Clauses 3.4 and 3.5 apply to a Day-Care Procedure, except for cataract surgery, for which clause 4.4 applies.

4.6 **Procedures Performed as Outpatient.** A minor procedure performed in the outpatient department of a Hospital or clinic without the need for the facilities of a Hospital, such as suturing, dressing, nebulisation or an injection, is not a Day-Care Procedure and is payable only to the extent provided in Section 5.

5. OUTPATIENT BENEFITS

5.1 **Outpatient Benefit.** The Company shall pay the fees of a Medical Practitioner for consultation, the cost of diagnostic tests prescribed by a Medical Practitioner, and the cost of medicines prescribed by a Medical Practitioner, up to the Outpatient Limit stated in the Schedule of Benefits for the Policy Year. The benefit is available on a reimbursement basis only. Clause 8.1 applies to this benefit for an Illness. Clauses 8.3, 8.4 and 9.1 do not apply to it.

5.2 **Preventive Health Check-up.** The Company shall reimburse the cost of one preventive health check-up in each Policy Year, up to the limit stated in the Schedule of Benefits. This benefit is in addition to the Outpatient Limit in clause 5.1, is not subject to any Waiting Period, and does not require the Insured Person to have an Illness.

5.3 **Dental Treatment.** Outpatient dental treatment is not covered, except treatment of accidental injury to natural teeth as provided in clause 10.3.1.

5.4 **Post-Exposure Vaccination.** Notwithstanding clause 10.13, the cost of anti-rabies vaccination after an animal bite and anti-tetanus vaccination after an injury is payable within the Outpatient Limit.

5.5 **Prescription and Documentation.** Each item claimed under this Section must be supported by a prescription from a Medical Practitioner and by original bills. Items not prescribed, and vitamins, tonics and supplements excluded under clause 10.13, are not payable.

5.6 **Co-payment, Deductible and Network.** The age-based co-payment in clause 11.6 applies to claims under this Section. The non-network co-payment in clause 11.7 and the voluntary deductible in clause 14.2 do not apply to claims under this Section.

6. MATERNITY AND NEWBORN

6.1 **Maternity Benefit.** Subject to clauses 6.2 and 8.4, the Company shall pay the expenses of a female Insured Person for a normal delivery or a caesarean section in a Hospital, including consultations, tests and medicines for pre-natal care during the pregnancy and post-natal care during the sixty (60) days after discharge.

6.2 **Maternity Limits.** The Company's liability for all expenses described in clause 6.1 in respect of one delivery is limited to the following amounts for the Plan chosen:

6.2.1 for a normal delivery, the amount stated in the Schedule of Benefits for normal delivery; and

6.2.2 for a caesarean section, the amount stated in the Schedule of Benefits for caesarean section.

These limits include room rent, Hospital charges and Medical Practitioner's fees. Clauses 11.1 and 11.3 do not apply to expenses under clause 6.1.

6.3 **Number of Deliveries.** The Maternity Benefit is payable for not more than two (2) deliveries during the lifetime of the Insured Person under this Policy and any renewal of it. A delivery counts towards this limit once a benefit has been paid under clause 6.1.

6.4 **Complications of Pregnancy.** Notwithstanding clauses 6.3 and 8.4, Hospitalization for ectopic pregnancy, molar pregnancy, spontaneous miscarriage, pregnancy-induced hypertension, severe hyperemesis, or termination of pregnancy on medical advice because of a risk to the life of the mother arising before the onset of labour is payable as an Illness under Section 3. It is subject to clause 8.1 and is not subject to the limits in clause 6.2. A complication that arises from the onset of labour onwards forms part of the delivery and is subject to clause 6.2.

6.5 **Newborn Baby Cover.** If the delivery is payable under clause 6.1, the Company shall pay the Hospitalization expenses of the newborn baby for an Illness or Accident from the date of birth until the baby is ninety (90) days old, up to the Newborn Limit stated in the Schedule of Benefits. A Congenital External Anomaly of the newborn baby is not covered. After ninety (90) days the baby is covered only under a separate policy.

6.6 **Maternity Exclusions.** The Maternity Benefit and Newborn Baby Cover do not extend to (a) surrogacy or assisted reproduction (see clause 10.6); (b) voluntary termination of pregnancy other than as provided in clause 6.4; (c) pre-natal classes, lactation consultancy and similar non-medical services; or (d) routine well-baby care and routine vaccination of the newborn baby.

6.7 **Intimation of Expected Delivery.** A delivery is a Planned Treatment for the purposes of clause 13.2. The Insured Person shall inform the Company of the expected date of delivery and the Hospital chosen at least thirty (30) days before that date. If labour begins as an Emergency, clause 13.3 applies instead.

7. EMERGENCY AND AMBULANCE

7.1 **Emergency Hospitalization.** Pre-authorization under clause 13.2 is not required for Emergency Hospitalization. The Company shall pay for Emergency Hospitalization on the same terms as other Hospitalization under Section 3, subject to this Section.

7.2 **Intimation after Emergency Admission.** The Insured Person, or someone acting for the Insured Person, must inform the Company of an Emergency Hospitalization within twenty-four (24) hours of admission, or before discharge if discharge occurs earlier. The consequences of late intimation are set out in clause 13.4.

7.3 **Emergency Ambulance.** The Company shall pay the charges of a road ambulance used to take the Insured Person to the nearest Hospital capable of treating the Emergency, up to the amount stated in the Schedule of Benefits for each Emergency transport event, and for not more than two (2) events in one Hospitalization.

7.4 **Air and Water Ambulance.** Charges for transport by air ambulance, helicopter, boat or other means other than a road ambulance are not payable.

7.5 **Emergency in a Non-Network Hospital.** An Insured Person who has an Emergency may be treated at the nearest Hospital, whether or not it is a Network Hospital. If the nearest Network Hospital is more than twenty (20) kilometres away by road, or does not have the facilities or capacity to treat the Emergency (as certified by the treating Hospital), the non-network co-payment in clause 11.7 is waived for the whole Emergency Hospitalization. The waiver ends from the date on which the Company arranges a medically safe transfer to a Network Hospital and the Insured Person chooses not to transfer.

7.6 **Accidental Injury Treated Without Admission.** Notwithstanding clause 1.5, the Company shall pay for Medically Necessary treatment received in the emergency department of a Hospital within twenty-four (24) hours after an Accident, even if the Insured Person is not admitted, up to the amount stated in the Schedule of Benefits for each Accident. This clause does not apply to an Illness.

8. WAITING PERIODS

8.1 **Initial Waiting Period.** No claim is payable for Hospitalization or a Day-Care Procedure that begins within thirty (30) days after the inception date of the first policy issued by the Company to the Insured Person, if it is for an Illness. This clause is subject to clause 8.2 and does not apply on renewal of a policy without a break.

8.2 **Accident Exception.** The Waiting Periods in clauses 8.1 and 8.3 do not apply to treatment that is the direct result of an Accident, whenever the Accident occurs after the inception date. This clause does not alter clauses 8.4 and 9.1, except as provided in clause 9.6.

8.3 **Specified Conditions: 24 Months.** No claim is payable for treatment of any of the following conditions until twenty-four (24) months of continuous cover under this Policy have been completed: (a) cataract; (b) hernia of every type, and hydrocele; (c) hysterectomy and myomectomy for benign conditions; (d) benign prostatic hypertrophy; (e) calculus diseases of the kidney, ureter and bladder, and gallstones; (f) haemorrhoids, fissure and fistula-in-ano; (g) joint replacement surgery of the hip, knee or shoulder; (h) degenerative disorders of the spine, including prolapsed intervertebral disc and spondylosis, requiring surgery; (i) varicose veins; (j) tonsillectomy, adenoidectomy, septoplasty and sinus surgery; (k) benign ovarian cysts and benign breast lumps; (l) benign thyroid disorders, including goitre; and (m) Congenital Internal Anomalies.

8.3.1 Joint replacement surgery that is required as the direct result of an Accident is not subject to clause 8.3 (see clause 8.2). Joint replacement surgery required because of osteoarthritis, osteoporosis, avascular necrosis or any other degenerative or non-traumatic condition is subject to clause 8.3.

8.4 **Maternity Waiting Period.** The Maternity Benefit in clause 6.1 and the Newborn Baby Cover in clause 6.5 are payable only if the Policy has been in force continuously for twenty-four (24) months before the date of admission for the delivery. This clause does not apply to a complication payable under clause 6.4.

8.5 **More Than One Waiting Period.** If more than one Waiting Period applies to a claim, the longest of them applies. If a condition listed in clause 8.3 is also a Pre-Existing Condition, the thirty-six (36) month Waiting Period in clause 9.1 applies and the twenty-four (24) month period in clause 8.3 does not.

8.6 **Continuity and Enhancement.** Waiting Periods that have been served under a policy continue to count if the policy is renewed without a break, including a renewal made within the grace period in clause 15.4. If the Sum Insured is increased at renewal, the Waiting Periods in this Section and in Section 9 apply afresh to the amount of the increase only.

8.7 **Date by Which a Waiting Period is Measured.** A Waiting Period is satisfied if the date of admission (for Hospitalization) or the date of the procedure (for a Day-Care Procedure) falls after the Waiting Period ends. The date on which the condition was first diagnosed or first caused symptoms does not alter this rule. Whether a condition is a Pre-Existing Condition is decided under clause 1.9.

9. PRE-EXISTING CONDITIONS

9.1 **Waiting Period for Pre-Existing Conditions.** No claim is payable for the treatment of a Pre-Existing Condition, or for a complication of it, until thirty-six (36) months of continuous cover under this Policy have been completed.

9.2 **Declaration in the Proposal.** The Policyholder must declare every Pre-Existing Condition in the proposal form. A Pre-Existing Condition that has been declared and accepted by the Company remains subject to clause 9.1, unless the Policy Schedule or an endorsement states otherwise.

9.3 **Complications.** A condition that arises directly from a Pre-Existing Condition, or is a recognised complication of it, is treated as part of that Pre-Existing Condition for the purposes of clause 9.1. A condition does not become a complication of a Pre-Existing Condition merely because the Insured Person has both.

9.4 **Cover after the Waiting Period.** After the Waiting Period in clause 9.1 has been completed, treatment of a Pre-Existing Condition is covered in the same way as any other Illness, subject to the Sum Insured, the sub-limits and the exclusions in Section 10.

9.5 **Undisclosed Pre-Existing Conditions.** Notwithstanding clause 9.4, completion of the Waiting Period does not prevent the Company from exercising its rights under clause 15.1 if the Pre-Existing Condition was not disclosed in the proposal, until the period in clause 15.3 has ended.

9.6 **Accident Affecting a Pre-Existing Condition.** Notwithstanding clause 9.1, treatment of an injury caused by an Accident is not excluded only because the injured part of the body was affected by a Pre-Existing Condition. The part of the treatment that is attributable to the Pre-Existing Condition rather than to the Accident remains subject to clause 9.1.

10. PERMANENT EXCLUSIONS

10.1 **General Rule.** The Company is not liable for any claim directly or indirectly caused by, arising out of or attributable to any of the matters listed in this Section 10. An exception to an exclusion applies only to the extent and on the conditions stated in the exception, and in accordance with clause 2.5.3.

10.2 **Cosmetic and Plastic Surgery.** Cosmetic, aesthetic or plastic surgery, and any treatment whose purpose is to improve appearance, including hair transplant, rhinoplasty for appearance, liposuction, breast augmentation and tattoo removal, are excluded.

10.2.1 The exclusion in clause 10.2 does not apply to (a) reconstructive surgery that is necessary because of an Accident, if treatment begins within twelve (12) months after the Accident; (b) treatment of burns, including reconstructive surgery after burns; and (c) reconstructive surgery after surgery for cancer, such as breast reconstruction after mastectomy.

10.3 **Dental Treatment.** Dental treatment and surgery of any kind, including treatment of the teeth, gums and supporting structures, dentures, crowns, bridges and dental implants, is excluded.

10.3.1 The exclusion in clause 10.3 does not apply to treatment that is necessary because of accidental injury to natural teeth, including repair or replacement of the natural teeth damaged in the Accident, if treatment begins within ninety (90) days after the Accident. Treatment under this clause is payable on an outpatient basis within the limit in clause 7.6, or on Hospitalization under Section 3.

10.3.2 The exclusion in clause 10.3 does not apply to surgery for a cyst, tumour or other pathological condition of the jaw that requires Hospitalization and is not of dental origin.

10.4 **Refractive Error.** Correction of refractive error by spectacles, contact lenses, laser surgery (including LASIK) or any other procedure, is excluded unless the refractive error exceeds seven and a half (7.5) dioptres of spherical equivalent and the procedure is carried out as a Day-Care Procedure or on Hospitalization.

10.5 **Obesity and Weight Control.** Treatment for obesity or for weight control, including weight-reduction programmes and drugs, is excluded. Notwithstanding this exclusion, bariatric surgery is payable if (a) the Insured Person has a body mass index of 40 or more, or of 35 or more together with a serious weight-related condition certified by the treating Medical Practitioner; (b) the surgery is recommended by a qualified surgeon after at least twelve (12) months of documented medically supervised weight management; and (c) thirty-six (36) months of continuous cover under this Policy have been completed. Pre-authorization under clause 13.2 is mandatory.

10.6 **Reproductive Treatment.** Treatment for infertility or sterility, assisted reproduction (including in-vitro fertilisation), surrogacy, voluntary sterilisation, contraception, and sexual dysfunction is excluded. Voluntary termination of pregnancy is excluded except as provided in clause 6.4.

10.7 **Self-Inflicted Injury and Substance Abuse.** Intentional self-injury, attempted suicide, and treatment for the abuse of or addiction to alcohol, drugs or other substances, and any Illness or injury caused by them, are excluded. This clause does not apply to emergency treatment of poisoning that did not result from the Insured Person’s voluntary consumption.

10.8 **Hazardous Activities.** An injury or Illness arising from taking part in professional sport, motor racing, aerial adventure sports, scuba diving below thirty (30) metres, or mountaineering above three thousand (3,000) metres is excluded. Recreational activities that are not professional, such as walking, jogging, swimming and trekking below three thousand (3,000) metres, are not excluded.

10.9 **War and Nuclear Risks.** Injury or Illness caused by war, invasion, act of a foreign enemy, hostilities (whether war is declared or not), civil war, or by nuclear weapons, ionising radiation or contamination by radioactivity from nuclear fuel or waste, is excluded. Radiotherapy given as treatment for a covered Illness is not excluded.

10.10 **Non-Medical Expenses.** Items that are not medical expenses are excluded, including registration, admission and service charges, toiletries, television, telephone, guest meals, attendant’s charges, laundry, and travel costs (other than as provided in Section 7). Consumables such as gloves, masks, syringes and dressings are excluded unless they form part of an inclusive package rate or of the Reasonable and Customary Charge for the procedure.

10.11 **Rest Cure, Convalescence and Custodial Care.** Admission for rest cure, rehabilitation, convalescence, custodial care, respite care or old-age care is excluded. Admission whose main purpose is diagnostic investigation or evaluation is also excluded (see clause 1.5.3), except that the cost of the investigation is payable if it leads immediately to Medically Necessary treatment during the same admission.

10.12 **Congenital External Anomalies.** Treatment of a Congenital External Anomaly is excluded. A Congenital Internal Anomaly is not excluded by this clause but is subject to clause 8.3(m).

10.13 **Supplements and Routine Vaccination.** Vitamins, tonics, nutritional supplements and health foods are excluded unless prescribed as part of the treatment of a diagnosed Illness during Hospitalization. Routine and preventive vaccination is excluded, except as provided in clause 5.4.

10.14 **Circumcision and Gender Reassignment.** Circumcision is excluded unless it is Medically Necessary for the treatment of an Illness or an injury caused by an Accident. Gender reassignment surgery is excluded.

10.15 **External Aids and Appliances.** Spectacles, contact lenses, hearing aids, wheelchairs, crutches, walking aids, orthopaedic belts and similar external devices are excluded. This clause does not apply to internal implants and prostheses described in clause 3.1(e).

10.16 **Unregistered Practitioners and Unlawful Acts.** Treatment by a person who is not a Medical Practitioner, treatment given in an establishment that is not a Hospital, and any injury or Illness arising from the Insured Person committing a criminal offence, are excluded.

11. SUB-LIMITS AND CO-PAYMENT

11.1 **Room Rent Limit.** Room rent, boarding and nursing charges are payable up to one per cent (1%) of the base Sum Insured for each day of Hospitalization, for a single private room or any lower category. The resulting daily amount for each Plan is stated in the Schedule of Benefits.

11.2 **Intensive Care Limit.** Charges for an intensive care unit (including a cardiac care unit and a high-dependency unit) are payable up to two per cent (2%) of the base Sum Insured for each day. The resulting daily amount for each Plan is stated in the Schedule of Benefits.

11.3 **Proportionate Deduction.** If the Insured Person occupies a room whose daily rent exceeds the limit in clause 11.1, the Company shall also reduce, in the same proportion that the limit bears to the actual daily rent, the charges that are linked to the room category, namely Medical Practitioner’s fees, operation theatre charges, nursing charges, procedure charges and consultation charges. The proportionate deduction does not apply to (a) intensive care charges; (b) a Day-Care Procedure; (c) expenses payable under clause 6.1; (d) charges that do not depend on room category, such as implants, medicines, diagnostic tests and ambulance; or (e) an Emergency Hospitalization in which no room within the limit in clause 11.1 was available in the Hospital, as certified by the Hospital, in which case the room of the next higher category is treated as within the limit.

11.4 **Ambulance Limit.** Ambulance charges are limited to two thousand rupees (INR 2,000) in each Hospitalization.

11.5 **Other Sub-Limits.** The per-eye limit for cataract surgery (clause 4.4), the maternity limits (clause 6.2), the Newborn Limit (clause 6.5), the AYUSH limit (clause 3.6), the domiciliary limit (clause 3.7) and the Outpatient Limit (clause 5.1) are sub-limits within the Sum Insured and do not increase it. Any amount above a sub-limit is borne by the Insured Person.

11.6 **Age-Based Co-payment.** If the Insured Person has completed sixty (60) years of age on the date of admission or, for an outpatient claim, on the date of the bill, the Insured Person shall bear twenty per cent (20%) of every admissible claim under Sections 3 to 7, calculated in accordance with clause 14.6.

11.7 **Non-Network Co-payment.** If the Insured Person is treated in a Non-Network Hospital, the Insured Person shall bear ten per cent (10%) of the admissible claim under Section 3, Section 4 and Section 7, calculated in accordance with clause 14.6. This co-payment does not apply where it is waived under clause 7.5.

11.8 **Cumulative Co-payments.** If both clause 11.6 and clause 11.7 apply to a claim, the percentages are added and the Insured Person shall bear thirty per cent (30%) of the amount determined at Step 3 of clause 14.6.

11.9 **Specific Limit Prevails.** If a limit in this Section 11 differs from a limit stated for the same benefit in Sections 3 to 7, the limit in the specific benefit clause prevails over the limit in this Section 11. For example, the amount in clause 7.3 prevails over the amount in clause 11.4 for Emergency ambulance transport.

12. NETWORK AND NON-NETWORK HOSPITALS

12.1 **Network Hospitals and Cashless Treatment.** The Insured Person may obtain cashless treatment at a Network Hospital by following clause 13.1. The list of Network Hospitals is published on the Company’s website and may change from time to time. The Insured Person should confirm the status of the Hospital before admission.

12.2 **Treatment at a Non-Network Hospital.** Treatment at a Non-Network Hospital is payable on a reimbursement basis under Section 13. The co-payment in clause 11.7 applies. The Company may limit the charges to the Reasonable and Customary Charges, taking the rates agreed with comparable Network Hospitals in the same city as a benchmark.

12.3 **Change in Network Status.** Whether a Hospital is a Network Hospital is decided on the date of admission. If a Hospital ceases to be a Network Hospital after the Insured Person is admitted, it is treated as a Network Hospital until discharge. A pre-authorization approved for a Network Hospital that ceases to be one before admission lapses, and the Insured Person may request a fresh pre-authorization.

12.4 **Cashless Treatment Not a Final Admission of Liability.** Approval of cashless treatment is based on the information available at the time and is not a final admission of liability. The Company may decline payment of an item that is excluded or not admissible, and the Insured Person shall pay that item to the Hospital.

13. PRE-AUTHORIZATION AND CLAIM PROCEDURE

13.1 **Cashless Procedure.** To obtain cashless treatment at a Network Hospital, the Insured Person must submit a pre-authorization request on the form specified by the Company, signed by the treating Medical Practitioner. The Company shall decide a complete request within three (3) hours. On discharge, the Company shall give the final authorisation within three (3) hours of receiving the final bill and discharge summary.

13.2 **Pre-Authorization for Planned Treatment.** For Hospitalization or a Day-Care Procedure that is planned in advance and that can be delayed without risk to the Insured Person (Planned Treatment), the Insured Person must obtain the Company’s written pre-authorization at least seventy-two (72) hours before admission.

13.3 **Intimation of Emergency Hospitalization.** For Emergency Hospitalization, pre-authorization is not required. The Insured Person must give intimation to the Company within twenty-four (24) hours of admission, or before discharge if discharge occurs earlier, as stated in clause 7.2.

13.4 **Consequences of Non-Compliance.**

13.4.1 If Planned Treatment is undertaken without pre-authorization under clause 13.2, cashless treatment is not available. The claim may be made on a reimbursement basis, and the admissible amount shall be reduced by ten per cent (10%) unless the Insured Person shows that obtaining pre-authorization was not reasonably practicable.

13.4.2 If intimation of an Emergency Hospitalization is given after twenty-four (24) hours but within seventy-two (72) hours of admission, the Company shall not reject the claim on that ground if the delay is shown to have been caused by the condition of the Insured Person or by circumstances beyond the Insured Person’s control. If intimation is given after seventy-two (72) hours of admission, the Company may reject the claim on that ground unless the Insured Person was incapacitated and no other person could reasonably have informed the Company.

13.5 **Documents for Reimbursement.** A claim for reimbursement must be accompanied by (a) the completed claim form; (b) original bills and receipts; (c) the discharge summary and, for a surgical procedure, the operation notes; (d) investigation reports and prescriptions; (e) proof of identity of the Insured Person; and (f) in case of an Accident, the first information report or medico-legal certificate where applicable.

13.6 **Time Limits for Filing Claims.** The claim documents must be submitted to the Company (a) for Hospitalization or a Day-Care Procedure, within thirty (30) days after the date of discharge; (b) for Pre-Hospitalization expenses, together with the claim in (a); (c) for Post-Hospitalization expenses, within fifteen (15) days after the end of the Post-Hospitalization period; and (d) for outpatient expenses and preventive health check-up, within thirty (30) days after the date of the bill.

13.7 **Condonation of Delay.** Notwithstanding clause 13.6, the Company may condone a delay of up to sixty (60) days if the Insured Person gives genuine and documented reasons for it. No claim is payable if the documents are submitted more than ninety (90) days after the date of discharge or, for the claims in clause 13.6(c) and (d), more than ninety (90) days after the date from which the time in clause 13.6 runs.

13.8 **Settlement Timelines.** The Company shall settle or reject a claim within fifteen (15) days after receiving the last necessary document. If the Company decides to investigate the claim, it shall complete the investigation and settle or reject the claim within forty-five (45) days after receiving the last necessary document. If payment of an admissible claim is delayed beyond these periods, the Company shall pay interest at two per cent (2%) above the prevailing bank rate from the date of receipt of the last necessary document until the date of payment.

13.9 **Company’s Rights to Verify.** The Company may require the Insured Person to be examined by a Medical Practitioner chosen by the Company, at the Company’s cost; may inspect the Hospital’s records; and may obtain a second medical opinion. The Insured Person shall give all reasonable assistance. If the Insured Person fails to cooperate without good reason, the Company may reject the claim.

13.10 **Repudiation.** If the Company rejects a claim in whole or in part, it shall tell the Insured Person in writing the reasons and the clauses of this Policy on which the rejection is based. The Insured Person may ask for a review under clause 15.11.

14. SUM INSURED, DEDUCTIBLES AND BONUS

14.1 **Sum Insured as an Annual Aggregate.** The Sum Insured, together with any bonus added under clause 14.3, is the maximum aggregate amount payable for all claims arising in a Policy Year. An unused Sum Insured does not carry forward, except as provided in clause 14.3.

14.2 **Voluntary Deductible.** On Plan B or Plan C, the Policyholder may choose at inception or renewal a voluntary deductible of INR 25,000 or INR 50,000 in return for a premium discount. The deductible applies in each Policy Year to the total of the admissible claims, until the amount of the deductible has been absorbed. It does not apply to claims under Section 5. It cannot be changed during a Policy Year.

14.3 **No-Claim Bonus.** For each Policy Year without a claim, the Sum Insured for the following Policy Year is increased by ten per cent (10%) of the base Sum Insured, up to a maximum of fifty per cent (50%) of the base Sum Insured. A Policy Year is without a claim if no amount has been paid or is payable under Sections 3, 4, 6 or 7 in respect of it. Claims under Section 5 do not affect the bonus.

14.4 **Reduction of Bonus after a Claim.** If a claim is paid in a Policy Year, the accumulated bonus is reduced at the next renewal by ten per cent (10%) of the base Sum Insured, but not below zero. The base Sum Insured is not reduced.

14.5 **Reinstatement of Sum Insured.** If the Sum Insured and bonus for a Policy Year are used up, the Company shall reinstate an amount equal to the base Sum Insured once in that Policy Year. The reinstated amount is available only for an Illness or injury that is unrelated to the Illness or injury for which claims have already been paid in the same Policy Year. It is not available for the claim that used up the Sum Insured, does not carry forward, and does not restore any bonus.

14.6 **Order of Calculation.** The amount payable on a claim is calculated in this order:

14.6.1 Step 1: take the total expenses incurred and remove the amounts that are excluded under Section 10, are not medical expenses, or exceed the Reasonable and Customary Charges.

14.6.2 Step 2: apply the limits and sub-limits in Sections 3 to 7 and clauses 11.1 to 11.5, including any proportionate deduction under clause 11.3.

14.6.3 Step 3: deduct any voluntary deductible that remains to be absorbed under clause 14.2.

14.6.4 Step 4: apply the co-payment percentage under clauses 11.6 to 11.8 to the amount remaining after Step 3.

14.6.5 Step 5: limit the amount to the Sum Insured, bonus and reinstated amount still available for the Policy Year.

14.7 **Enhancement of Sum Insured.** The Sum Insured may be increased only at renewal and is subject to the Company’s underwriting. Clause 8.6 applies to the amount of the increase.

15. GENERAL CONDITIONS

15.1 **Disclosure and Misrepresentation.** The Policy is issued on the basis that all statements in the proposal form and other documents are true and complete. If the Policyholder or the Insured Person has misrepresented, concealed or failed to disclose a material fact, whether intentionally or not, the Company may refuse a claim affected by it and, subject to clause 15.3, may cancel the Policy.

15.2 **Fraud.** If a claim is in any respect fraudulent, or any false statement or declaration is made or used in support of it, or any fraudulent means or devices are used by the Insured Person or anyone acting on the Insured Person’s behalf to obtain a benefit, the Company shall reject the claim, and may cancel the Policy and forfeit the premium. Fraud includes (a) a false statement made with intent to deceive; (b) submission of forged or altered documents; (c) a claim for treatment that was not received; and (d) collusion with a Hospital or provider to inflate a claim. The Company shall give written notice of the allegation and a reasonable opportunity to respond before it rejects a claim on the ground of fraud.

15.3 **Moratorium.** After sixty (60) continuous months of cover under this Policy and its renewals, no claim shall be contested on the ground of misrepresentation or non-disclosure, except in a case of fraud under clause 15.2. This clause does not affect the exclusions in Section 10 or the limits and Waiting Periods in this Policy.

15.4 **Premium and Grace Period.** The premium is payable in advance. A grace period of thirty (30) days is allowed after the renewal date for payment of the renewal premium. No claim is payable for expenses incurred during the grace period. If the renewal premium is paid within the grace period, the Policy is renewed without a break in continuity.

15.5 **Renewal.** The Policy is renewable for life. The Company shall not refuse renewal because of the claims experience or health of the Insured Person, except in the case of fraud, misrepresentation or non-cooperation. The Company may revise the premium rates for the product as a whole, with at least three (3) months’ written notice to the Policyholder.

15.6 **Free-Look Period.** The Policyholder may return the Policy within fifteen (15) days after receiving it if the terms are not acceptable. On return, the Company shall refund the premium after deducting the proportionate risk premium for the period on cover, the cost of any medical examination and stamp duty. The free-look right is not available if a claim has been made.

15.7 **Cancellation by the Policyholder.** The Policyholder may cancel the Policy at any time by giving written notice. The Company shall refund a share of the annual premium according to how long the Policy has been in force: seventy-five per cent (75%) if up to three (3) months, fifty per cent (50%) if more than three (3) and up to six (6) months, twenty-five per cent (25%) if more than six (6) and up to nine (9) months, and nothing after nine (9) months. No refund is payable if a claim has been made in the Policy Year.

15.8 **Cancellation by the Company.** The Company may cancel the Policy only for fraud, misrepresentation or non-cooperation, by giving fifteen (15) days’ written notice. Except in a case of fraud, the Company shall refund the premium for the unexpired period.

15.9 **Other Insurance.** If the Insured Person has other health insurance that covers the same expenses, the Insured Person may choose which insurer to claim from first. The Company shall not pay more than the actual expenses incurred, and where another insurer has paid part of a claim, the Company shall pay the balance that is admissible under this Policy.

15.10 **Subrogation.** The Insured Person shall do everything necessary to allow the Company to recover from a third party any amount paid under this Policy, and shall not do anything to prejudice the Company’s right of recovery.

15.11 **Grievance Redressal.** A complaint may be made to the Company’s grievance officer. The Company shall acknowledge it within three (3) days and resolve it within fifteen (15) days. If the Insured Person is not satisfied, the Insured Person may approach the insurance ombudsman or the courts where the law allows.

15.12 **Governing Law and Jurisdiction.** This Policy is governed by the laws of India. Disputes are subject to the jurisdiction of the competent courts at Mumbai.

15.13 **Notices.** Any notice or communication to the Company must be in writing, or by email to the address stated in the Policy Schedule, and is effective on receipt. The Company shall send notices to the last address given by the Policyholder. The Policyholder must tell the Company of any change of address.

16. SCHEDULE OF BENEFITS

16.1 **Plan Limits.** The following monetary limits apply, in Indian Rupees (INR), for the Plan shown in the Policy Schedule.

Benefit	Plan A	Plan B	Plan C	Clause
Sum Insured	5,00,000	10,00,000	25,00,000	1.15
Room rent per day (1% of Sum Insured)	5,000	10,000	25,000	11.1
Intensive care per day (2% of Sum Insured)	10,000	20,000	50,000	11.2
Cataract surgery, per eye	25,000	30,000	40,000	4.4
Maternity, normal delivery	40,000	60,000	80,000	6.2.1
Maternity, caesarean section	60,000	90,000	1,20,000	6.2.2
Newborn Limit	20,000	30,000	40,000	6.5
Emergency ambulance, per transport event	3,000	3,000	3,000	7.3
Ambulance (general), per Hospitalization	2,000	2,000	2,000	11.4
Accidental injury treated without admission, per Accident	10,000	10,000	10,000	7.6
AYUSH Treatment (50% of Sum Insured)	2,50,000	5,00,000	12,50,000	3.6
Domiciliary Hospitalization (10% of Sum Insured)	50,000	1,00,000	2,50,000	3.7
Outpatient Limit, per Policy Year	5,000	10,000	15,000	5.1
Preventive health check-up, per Policy Year	1,500	2,500	4,000	5.2
Voluntary deductible options	Not available	25,000 or 50,000	25,000 or 50,000	14.2

16.2 **Waiting Periods.** The following Waiting Periods apply, measured in continuous months or days of cover.

Waiting Period	Duration	Clause
Initial Waiting Period for Illness	30 days	8.1
Initial Waiting Period for Accident	None	8.2
Specified conditions	24 months	8.3
Joint replacement caused by Accident	None	8.3.1
Maternity Benefit and Newborn Baby Cover	24 months	8.4
Pre-Existing Conditions	36 months	9.1
Bariatric surgery (where permitted)	36 months	10.5

16.3 **Co-payments.** The following co-payments apply to the admissible claim after the steps in clause 14.6.

Co-payment	Rate	Clause
Insured Person aged 60 or more	20%	11.6
Treatment in a Non-Network Hospital	10%	11.7
Both of the above	30%	11.8
Non-network co-payment in an Emergency (nearest Network Hospital over 20 km away or unable to treat)	Waived	7.5
Non-network co-payment on outpatient claims	Not applicable	5.6

16.4 **Time Limits.** The following time limits apply.

Event	Time limit	Clause
Pre-authorization for Planned Treatment	At least 72 hours before admission	13.2
Intimation of Emergency Hospitalization	Within 24 hours of admission	7.2, 13.3
Pre-Hospitalization period	30 days	1.17.1
Post-Hospitalization period	60 days	1.17.2
Filing of hospitalization claim	Within 30 days of discharge	13.6
Longest delay that may be condoned	60 further days (90 days in total)	13.7
Free-look period	15 days	15.6
Grace period for renewal	30 days	15.4
Moratorium	60 continuous months	15.3

16.5 **Status of this Schedule.** This Schedule of Benefits is part of the Policy. The amounts in it prevail over the amounts in the body of the Policy in accordance with clause 2.5.4. The conditions of each benefit are those stated in the clause referred to in the last column.

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